Guido Ardizzone

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Research Fields

Primary: Sovereign Debt, Macro-Finance, Banking

Secondary: International Finance, Sanctions and Geopolitical Risk

Education

Geneva Graduate Institute (IHEID) — **Sep. 2022 – Present**
PhD in Economics — *Geneva, Switzerland*
Supervisor: Ugo Panizza. Second reader: Rui Esteves.

Bocconi University — **Sep. 2018 – Apr. 2021**
MSc in Economics and Social Sciences, cum laude — *Milan, Italy*

Bocconi University — **Sep. 2015 – Oct. 2018**
BSc in Economics and Social Sciences — *Milan, Italy*

Work Experience

International Monetary Fund (IMF) — **Jun. 2026 – Aug. 2026**
Fund Intern, Debt Policy Division (Strategy, Policy & Review Department) — *Washington, DC, USA*

The World Bank Group — **Jul. 2025 – Aug. 2025**
Visiting PhD Student — *Washington, DC, USA*

Geneva Graduate Institute (IHEID) — **Jan. 2023 – Jun. 2025**
Research Assistant to Prof. Rui Esteves (SNF-funded project) — *Geneva, Switzerland*

The World Bank Group — **Jan. 2023 – Jun. 2023**
Short-Term Consultant (part-time) — *Geneva, Switzerland*

BAFFI CAREFIN Research Center, Bocconi University — **Sep. 2021 – Jun. 2022**
Research Assistant (Carlo Altomonte) — *Milan, Italy*

UCLA Anderson School of Management — **Jul. 2021 – Jun. 2022**
Research Assistant (Paola Giuliano) — *Milan, Italy*

European Commission — **Feb. 2021 – Jun. 2021**
Trainee, Chief Economist Team, DG Competition — *Brussels, Belgium*

Teaching Experience

Geneva Graduate Institute (IHEID) — **Sep. 2024 – Present**
Teaching Assistant — *Geneva, Switzerland*

Fall '24, '25	Macroeconomics I (Master)
Spring '25, '26	Microeconomics II (Master)

Grants and Scholarships

2026	Gallatin Excellence Scholarship, visiting semester at the Princeton Sovereign Finance Lab (Spring 2027)
2022–2026	IHEID Excellence Scholarship
2021	Zegna Founder's Scholarship Program, Ermenegildo Zegna Group

Working Papers and Work in Progress (* Job Market Paper)

Sovereign Risk and the Maturity of Bank Credit*

Abstract: *This paper studies how banks adjust the maturity of credit when sovereign stress rises. I use administrative data from the Banco de Portugal that track monthly bank–firm credit relationships and the maturity of outstanding credit during the 2010–2012 European sovereign debt crisis. I exploit differences in banks' pre-crisis exposure to distressed sovereign debt to compare lending to the same firm by banks with different exposure. I find that banks do not reduce lending proportionately across maturities. Relative to less exposed banks lending to the same firm, banks more exposed to sovereign risk cut medium- and long-term credit, while their short-term credit does not differ, so the maturity of credit shortens within continuing relationships. The contraction in medium- and long-term credit is larger for small, highly leveraged and financially constrained firms. At the firm level, firms borrowing from more exposed banks obtain less medium- and long-term credit and more short-term credit, and their total bank credit falls. They do not compensate by borrowing from other banks. Sovereign stress therefore reduces both the amount and the maturity of the bank credit available to firms.*

Senior Debt and Market Access with Agustín Velasquez and Mahamoud Islam (IMF)

Abstract: *Multilateral lending is a significant component of sovereign debt in emerging and developing economies. Because multilateral creditors receive de facto preferred creditor treatment, a larger stock of multilateral claims can affect the pricing of private sovereign debt through two opposing channels. On the one hand, official lending can ease financing constraints and rollover pressure, reducing the likelihood of distress. On the other hand, the seniority of multilateral claims leaves private creditors with a smaller residual claim in states of distress, potentially increasing their required compensation. We study how these forces interact using an annual panel of 55 emerging and developing economies over 2004–2024. We measure senior creditor exposure as the share of external public and publicly guaranteed debt owed to multilateral creditors and relate it to sovereign spreads from the JP Morgan EMBI Global. Using a quadratic specification with country and year fixed effects, we find that (i) on average, the relationship between senior creditor exposure and sovereign spreads is non-linear, with the marginal association becoming positive at about 40 percent of external debt; (ii) the non-linearity is state dependent and concentrated among more vulnerable sovereigns; and (iii) it is specific to multilateral creditor exposure, consistent with the role of de facto seniority. The results are robust to alternative specifications, additional controls, global risk factors, and excluding IMF credit from the exposure measure. We interpret the evidence as consistent with a trade-off between the catalytic benefits of official finance and the dilution of private claims created by senior creditor exposure.*

Sanctions, Lending, and the Bank Ownership Channel with Matteo Ficarra (ESM)

Abstract: *This paper examines the impact of sanctions on bank lending with a focus on the role of bank ownership. Using balance sheet and ownership data for over 1,800 banks in 56 emerging market economies and 259 sanction episodes between 1995 and 2020, we find that in response to sanctions foreign banks significantly reduce credit supply, particularly to firms, in line with a flight-to-safety type of behaviour. As private domestic banks are unable to increase lending, state-owned banks partially absorb credit demand by expanding loans to both firms and households, suggesting a countercyclical response. This asymmetric response is consistent across different sanction types, but particularly strong for trade and financial sanctions. Our findings unveil a new channel to assess the effectiveness of sanctions, highlighting the importance of banks' ownership structure, and offers novel insights on the response of cross-border credit flows to sanctions.*

Policy Publications and Press (written with Tortuga)

Campioni europei di debito – *lavoce.info, 28/04/2026*

Nadef e Patto di stabilità: il diavolo è nei dettagli – *lavoce.info, 24/10/2023*

Perché la riforma del Patto di Stabilità e Crescita così com'è non va – *Econopoly (Il Sole 24 Ore), 18/01/2023*

Quanto costa realizzare il programma elettorale del Partito Democratico – *Fanpage.it, 14/09/2022*

Quanto costa realizzare il programma elettorale del Terzo polo di Azione e Italia Viva – *Fanpage.it, 12/09/2022*

Presentations

2026	IMF Debt Policy Division Seminar (Washington, DC)
2025–2026	IHEID–UNIGE Joint PhD Workshop (Geneva), Claude Code for Economic Research Workshop (Geneva), IHEID Brown Bag Lunch (Geneva)

Other Professional Services

Seminar Organizer: *IHEID Brown Bag Lunch PhD Seminars (2023–2026)*

Research Affiliations

Tortuga **2021 – 2026**
Senior Fellow

Languages and IT Skills

- **Languages**: Italian (native), English (full professional proficiency), Spanish (advanced)
- **Software**: Stata, R, Matlab (Dynare), LaTeX, Claude Code, MS Office

References

Prof. Ugo Panizza
Professor of Economics
Geneva Graduate Institute (IHEID)
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Prof. Rui Esteves
Full Professor
Geneva Graduate Institute (IHEID)
rui.esteves@graduateinstitute.ch

Agustín Velasquez
Senior Economist
International Monetary Fund (IMF)
AVelasquez@imf.org